

What is Growth Hack?

Growth Hack is an annual, global hackathon in which ETS colleagues gather in teams to collaboratively engineer innovative concepts. The event is held over a two-day period and often involves colleagues from other areas of the company, including Product and the Business. The goal is to focus on improving the experience for our Customers, Colleagues, Marketers, CCPs, etc. Improving these experiences will lead to many positive outcomes for Amex including building and fostering our work culture, which ultimately drives organizational success for Amex!

Growth Hack culminates in a showcase event featuring top hacks as voted upon by a global group of judges.

What and Why?
What? • Two-day global hack event • Colleagues gather to collaborate and engineer innovative solutions • Highlights the teamwork and innovation that makes our company special
Why? To provide an opportunity for: • Healthy competition and fun • Learning new skills and experimenting with different technologies • Meeting and collaborating with peers • Encouraging innovation and new feature/product development

What is changing for Growth Hack 2026?

Growth Hack 2026 is expanding cross-functional enterprise participation by bringing together colleagues from business, product, and technology functions. We have partnered with six Business Units (also know as Lines of Business) to identify key opportunity headlines/themes. These ideas will help teams think creatively, spark new solutions, and turn those opportunities into meaningful outcomes. The six Business Units/LOBs along with themes are:

GCS (Global Commercial Services – Raymond Joabar)

Transform Customer Data Exploration and Insights: Enable business teams to explore customer data through a conversational, self-service experience that uncovers actionable insights, supports better decision-making, and accelerates growth opportunities.

Modernize Business Travel Account Reconciliation: Simplify BTA reconciliation by improving data accessibility, automating reconciliation activities, and delivery more accurate, timely financial insights

Accelerate Supplier Enablement and Growth: Streamline supplier enablement to improve operational efficiency, strengthen decision-making, and accelerate supplier and network growth.

Transform the Complaints Management Experience: Simplify the end-to-end complaints process to improve colleague productivity, decision consistency, quality, and regulatory compliance.

Reimagine the Small Business Digital Experience: Simplify and connect the end-to-end digital journey to improve engagement and reduce customer effort for Small Business customers.

Transform Payroll Operations with AI: Streamline payroll operations to improve efficiency, accuracy, and accelerate the delivery of AI-enabled payroll capabilities.

GMNS (Global Merchant & Network Services – Anna Marrs)

Optimize Merchant Pricing Decisions: Enable more informed, data-driven pricing decisions that maximize value for merchants and the business.

Streamline MSB Remediation & Exception Management: Improve the identification and validation of Money Services Businesses by reducing manual effort and increasing consistency across disparate data sources and exception processes.

Strengthen Pricing Governance & Transparency: Improve visibility into pricing governance to support better decision-making and identify optimization opportunities.

Strengthen Regulatory Intelligence: Improve visibility into evolving regulatory developments to support earlier planning and proactive compliance.

Unlock Merchant Growth Opportunities: Enable earlier visibility into merchant growth opportunities and performance risks to drive proactive action.

Simplify Sponsorship Program Management: Streamline sponsorship management to improve collaboration, accelerate approvals, and increase operational efficiency.

GS (Global Servicing – Mohammed Badi)

Deliver Hyper-Personalized Customer Servicing Experiences: Leverage customer data and AI to anticipate customer needs, personalize interactions across channels, and strengthen engagement, loyalty, and satisfaction.

Modernize Operational Decision Support: Improve operational decision-making by providing intelligent decision support that enables colleagues to make faster, more consistent decisions.

Accelerate New Customer Care Professional Readiness: Reduce the time for new Customer Care Professionals (CCPs) to become proficient by improving training, knowledge retention, and confidence in a scalable learning environment.

USCS (U.S. Consumer Services – Howard Grosfield)

Reimagine Digital Membership with AI: Deliver an AI-powered membership experience that seamlessly connects servicing, benefits, travel, dining, and personalized recommendations.

Reimagine Travel Partner & Restaurant Onboarding and Enablement: Simplify onboarding and enablement for travel and restaurant partners to reduce manual effort, accelerate time to value, and create a more seamless partner experience.

Transform the Premium Digital Banking Experiences: Deliver personalized financial insights and premium experiences that strengthen the banking relationships by surfacing the right premium assets, insights, and experiences alongside the card relationship.

Strengthen Restaurant Health Insights: Proactively identify early indicators of restaurant performance and engagement risk to strengthen partner success and reduce churn.

Transform Restaurant Innovation Through Virtual Simulation: Transform Restaurant Innovation Through Virtual Simulation – Enable teams to test new restaurant experiences, workflows, and products in a virtual environment before real-world deployment.

ICS (International Card Services – Rafael Marquez)

Personalize International Customer Acquisition: Create a more personalized acquisition journey for international prospects to improve engagement, simplify the application process, and increase successful customer acquisition.

Optimize Sales Lead Prioritization: Improve lead prioritization to help sales teams focus on the highest-value opportunities while identifying potential risks and conflicts early.

Simplify Global Customer Onboarding: Reduce friction in the international application process by improving the onboarding experience for non-English-speaking customers, increasing completion rates and operational efficiency.

Strengthen Referral Integrity and Anti-Gaming Controls: Improve the detection of referral abuse and gaming behaviors by leveraging internal and external signals to better protect growth initiatives.

Modernize KYC/KYB Data Management: Improve customer data quality and streamline KYC/KYB processes to reduce manual effort, strengthen compliance, and improve operational efficiency.

Improve Customer Growth Targeting: Better identify customers with the highest growth potential to deliver more relevant engagement strategies and accelerate portfolio growth.

Accelerate Sales Knowledge Access: Simplify access to sales knowledge to improve productivity, consistency, and customer engagement.

Build a Trusted Business Community & Peer Matching Ecosystem: Help Small Business Card Members solve business challenges and grow by connecting them with highly

relevant peers, mentors, buyers, suppliers and expertise through an Amex-powered digital experience and intelligent matching engine.

ETS (Enterprise Technology Services – Ravi Radhakrishnan)

Reimagined Ways of Working: Reimagined Ways of Working

Transformational AI: Enterprise-wide AI and agentic intelligence for step-change

Differentiated Experiences: Design-led, human-centered, intelligent experiences

Adaptive Ecosystem: Modern & trusted platforms, data, security, and infrastructure that enable AI driven transformation

To view the catalog of BU-backed opportunities, click [HERE](#).

In addition, Growth Hack 2026 will continue to emphasize responsible, enterprise-safe AI experimentation. Teams are encouraged to develop sustainable, compliant, scalable solutions that leverage AI to solve business challenges and create measurable value for customers and colleagues.

NEW! Recognition for Cross-Functional Collaboration: To encourage broader enterprise engagement, teams that include representation from ETS, product, and business teams will earn bonus points during judging and receive a special Growth Hack 2026 digital badge!

Submitting Your Hack

Submit verified recording before 7:00 PM (local time) on September 24

Recordings can NOT be more than 5 minutes long!

Recordings can NOT be larger than 25 MB size!

GENERAL FAQ & REGISTRATION

Q: WHAT IS GROWTHHACK?

A: GrowthHack is a two-day global hack event where ETS, Product and business colleagues gather to collaborate and engineer innovative concepts. The GrowthHack event highlights the innovation that makes our company special!

Q: WHY DO WE RUN GROWTHHACK?

A: The GrowthHack event gives colleagues the opportunity for healthy competition along with fun! Colleagues can learn new skills/technologies, collaborate with peers all while encouraging innovation and new feature/product development.

Q: WHAT IS THE 2026 GROWTHHACK THEME?

A: The theme for GrowthHack 2026 is **Think Bigger. Move Faster. Build with AI** and participants will be challenged to use AI and other emerging technologies to develop solutions that enhance customer and colleague experiences, create enterprise value, and accelerate growth across the company.

Q: WHEN AND WHERE WILL THIS YEAR'S EVENT BE HELD ON MY CAMPUS?

A: In 2026, GrowthHack will align with our Amex Flex guidelines; meaning colleagues can participate in person or virtually on **September 23 - 24, 2026**.

Q: HOW IS THE JUDGING HANDLED?

A: Visit the [judging process page](#) on The Square for complete information.

Q: WHERE CAN I FIND MORE INFORMATION ABOUT GROWTHHACK?

A: In addition to the [GrowthHack Square page](#), you can also reach out to the [#growthhack](#) Slack channel.

REGISTRATION

Q: WHERE DO I REGISTER FOR GROWTHHACK?

A: Registration is open. Please visit the [GH Portal](#) to register yourself or your team or visit the [Registration and Preparation Square](#) page to learn more.

Q: HOW DO I REGISTER A TEAM? WHEN I GO INTO THE PORTAL, IT LOOKS LIKE I CAN ONLY REGISTER MYSELF?

A: Start by completing your individual registration. Once you enter your information and select “**Register,**” you’ll be taken to the next screen, where you can **create a team, find a team to join, or edit your registration.**

To create a team, select the “**Team Builder**” option and follow the prompts.

Q: WHY DID I GET 2 CONFIRMATION IDS WHEN I WAS REGISTERED ON A TEAM?

A: Once you register, you’ll be assigned a unique **Attendee ID**, which begins with “**A.**” This ID is specific to your individual registration.

If you register as part of a team, your team will also be assigned a **Team ID**, which begins with “**T.**” The Team ID is shared by everyone on your team, while your Attendee ID is unique to you.

Q: CAN A TEAM SUBMIT MORE THAN ONE IDEA?

A: No, when registering, a team can only submit ONE idea.

Q: HOW MANY TEAM MEMBERS CAN I HAVE ON A TEAM?

A: Each team can only have from **4 to 8 team members** and teams must consist of at least 50% engineers:

- - **Business Colleague Exception** - In 2025, we introduced the capability to expand team sizes beyond 8 members if the extra members were from the business. For 2026 we are increasing that to **TWO** members, **IF** the extra members are from the **business** (outside ETS and Product organizations).
 - Your team must still be comprised of at least 50% *Engineers with a maximum of 8 ETS or Product members.
 - Your team will be disqualified if you have more than 8 ETS or Product members on your team.

***What is an engineer?** Someone who has access to Amex development tools and will actively contribute code to the project.

Q: HOW DO I DETERMINE WHETHER A COLLEAGUE IS IN AN ETS, PRODUCT OR BUSINESS ORGANIZATION?

A: Enterprise Technology Services (ETS) colleagues ultimately report through the ETS organization led by Ravi Radhakrishnan.

For Product and Business colleagues, classification can be less straightforward, as they may belong to the same Business Unit or report into ETS. You can use the [Amex Departments](#) list to help determine the appropriate classification. If you're still unsure, reach out to the [GrowthHack](#) team for assistance.

Note: A colleague's title and the Business Unit they report into can sometimes help determine whether they are Product or Business.

Q: DO I HAVE TO SELECT A CATEGORY WHEN REGISTERING MY TEAM?

A: Yes. During the registration process, you will be asked what Line of Business you are hacking against and what opportunity statement/theme you are hacking. You can learn more by visiting the [2026 Information](#) page.

Q: CAN I PARTICIPATE AS AN INDIVIDUAL?

A: No, this is a team event. However, once registration is opened, you will be able to register as an individual, but you must find others to form a team before your registration will be considered complete (teams can be comprised of between 4-8 colleagues).

Q: I'M PLANNING TO REGISTER AS AN INDIVIDUAL. HOW DO I FIND OTHERS WHO MAY WANT TO FORM A TEAM?

A: Once registration opens, you'll be able to view a list of individuals interested in joining a team. In the meantime, you can also connect with others in the [#growthhack-findateam](#) Slack channel and teams looking for members will be able to use the new matching feature in the Portal.

Q: I AM NOT AN ETS COLLEAGUE. CAN I PARTICIPATE?

A: Yes! GrowthHack is open to all Amex colleagues!

Q: DOES A TEAM NEED TO BE FULLY BASED ON ONE CAMPUS TO COMPETE?

A: No. Since GrowthHack is a virtual/hybrid event, teams may include members from multiple campuses. However, each team must designate a primary campus during registration, and that campus will determine the time zone in which the team participates during the hack.

Q: HOW IS THE TEAM LOCATION DETERMINED? WHAT IF I HAVE AN EQUAL NUMBER OF COLLEAGUES FROM DIFFERENT LOCATIONS?

A: The team captain will select the location when registering the team. You should select the nearest location in which the majority of the members reside.

Q: CAN COLLEAGUES WHO ARE CODED AS VIRTUAL PARTICIPATE?

A: Yes. GrowthHack is open to all American Express colleagues.

Q: CAN CONTRACTORS PARTICIPATE?

A: No. Only full-time Amex colleagues can participate. See the [Terms of Participation](#) for more details.

Q: CAN I ADD, CHANGE OR REMOVE TEAM MEMBERS AFTER REGISTERING MY TEAM? HOW?

A: Yes, you can add, replace or remove team members until the day before the event. Use the GrowthHack Portal to make changes. You'll need your team confirmation ID (provided in your original confirmation email - ask your Team Captain or your local Campus contact if you need help locating it).

Q: IS THERE A LIST OF PREVIOUS HACK SUBMISSIONS SO THAT I CAN SEE IF MY IDEA HAS ALREADY BEEN ATTEMPTED?

A: No. With the recent portal uplift, the archive is not available but we do have the winners from 2025 posted [HERE](#).

Q: WHEN DO WE HAVE TO PROVIDE OUR TEAM'S HACK IDEA?

A: Registration will close on September 4 and **no late registrations will be accepted**. You will have up until **September 22 to refine and submit a brief description of your hack idea** within the GrowthHack Portal.

Q: WHEN DOES REGISTRATION CLOSE?

A: Registration has been extended to **September 11**.

GEN AI FAQ

Q: DO WE HAVE TO USE GEN AI AS PART OF OUR HACK IN 2026?

A: It is not mandatory to use Gen AI as part of your Hack. Its your hack and can be developed without a LLM model.

Q: WHAT IS LAUNCHPAD?

A: Launchpad is a sandbox type environment for Gen AI experimentation within American Express.

Q: IS THERE ANY SUPPORT THAT WILL BE GIVEN FOR GEN AI BEFORE AND DURING THE GROWTHHACK EVENT?

A: Yes, the following will be provided to help:

- - Information will be shared during InfoShare kickoff
 - A video will be shared to help understand steps
 - Integration Guide will be distributed (currently being finalized, in the interim you can visit this page to learn about the setup details: [Launchpad - Needs](#))
 - Office hour sessions to be scheduled in early September

Q: WHAT MODELS ARE SUPPORTED?

A: Below are the models that will be supported for GrowthHack 2026:

- - Open Source: LLAMA 3.2, LLAMA 3.3
 - Closed Source: Azure GPT 5.2, Gemini-3.1-flash-lite
 - Embedding Models: BGE-Large, ADA02

Q: WHEN WILL I RECEIVE MY CREDENTIALS?

A: Credentials will be shared 2-days before the GrowthHack event.

Q: CAN TEAM MEMBERS SHARE CREDENTIALS?

A: No, the GrowthHack scope will be different in 2026. Details on scope and EAG endpoints will be provided 2-days before the GrowthHack event.

Q: WHERE CAN I FIND THE REGISTERED AGENTS?

A: Portal is not available yet.

Q: WHERE CAN I FIND THE REGISTERED MCPs?

A: Portal is not available yet.

Q: WHAT CAPABILITIES ARE AVAILABLE TO USE?

A: Below are the capabilities that will be available for GrowthHack 2026:

- - Redaction
 - Substitution

- Safechain
- Local Memory

Q: WHAT SHOULD I DO IF I ENCOUNTER ANY ISSUES WITH LLMs?

A: The following will be provided to help:

- - Office hour sessions to be scheduled in early September
 - An integration guide and a video will be provided to explain step by step set up
 - If you run into any tech issues, reach out on Slack at **#genai-sre-support**.

HACKSTACK /UPSKILLING

Q: WHERE CAN I FIND INFORMATION ON THE AMEX SYSTEMS AND TOOLS AVAILABLE TO USE FOR OUR HACK?

A: Visit the [Amex Way Library](#) to learn about enterprise tools as well as "hack-ready" frameworks and APIs which will help you engineer more advanced solutions at a faster pace.

VOLUNTEERING

Q: I WOULD LIKE TO VOLUNTEER TO HELP, WHO SHOULD I CONTACT?

A: Please email [GrowthHack](#), Slack us in [#growthhack](#) or reach out to your local Campus contact.

The 2026 GrowthHack event will follow the same process as previous years and have two rounds of judging to determine the finalists and winners

Note: There will be a 1-week gap between Round 1 and Round 2 of judging.

ROUND 1

Preliminary Global Judging

September 28 - October 9

- - All projects will be reviewed
 - With the support of AI, judges will evaluate projects based on innovation, enterprise value, durability and scalability.
 - Each judge force-ranks their top 10 projects between 100 and 1,000 points

ROUND 2

Semifinal Judging

October 19 - October 23

- - ~25 projects progress from Round 1 into the semifinals. These projects will be selected based on their scores as well as representation across different business units.
 - Judges apply the same scoring criteria across all projects in this round to reach the top of the

GOAL - Ensure all LOBs / Business Units are represented through every phase of judging.

Judging Criteria

Judges will consider the following criteria while ranking hack teams. Judges can also provide written feedback in every scorecard to be shared with teams after the finalists are selected

In addition to standard criteria of innovation and completeness, judging can be expected to consider the "What makes a winning hack?" elements covered earlier.

- Recognize the environment we are in
- Use storytelling to convey your vision
- Partnering with business and product colleagues
- Scaling: Meeting the enterprise demand.

Criteria	Weight
Hack Feasibility and Scalability • Is the hack solution feasible for Production Rollout? • Can the hack idea scale to Amex volumes? • Will the hack adhere to Amex requirements of increasing control and compliance? • Does the hack idea protect and enhance the Amex brand?	30%
Innovation (Only some need apply)	30%

• Has the hack identified a new experience improvement opportunity that was previously unknown? • Does the hack re-invent an existing solution in a new and novel manner? • Does the solution create value through reduction or elimination? • Does the hack use existing capabilities in an expanded way?	
Business Unit Value • Has the hack identified a solution inline with an enumerated business unit theme? Does it solve a known business need? • Were business partners and/or processes owners consulted while hacking, or members of the hack team? • How much does the hack improve code, products, or processes? • Can the solution be leveraged by multiple applications or domains?	30%
Hack Completeness • How complete is the hack? Is it a real working prototype, Proof of Concept, partially coded, or animation/mockup? • How much complexity/effort is left to complete post-hack? • Does Amex have, or could it easily procure the skills, assets, and dependencies for Prod implementation?	10%

GrowthHack 2026 | September 23 - 24

Square: <http://go.aexp.com/hack>

Slack: [#growthhack](#)

Meeting with Meagan Mcullum (Director of implementation resy)

Meeting recap (with Megan):

Meeting: Resy Onboarding Process

Status: In progress (meeting transcript available)

Key Takeaways

1. Current Resy Onboarding Model

- Meagan explained the onboarding flow used for Resy and Tock partners. After contract signing, implementation specialists guide partners through setup and launch.
- Sales teams are expected to determine product fit before onboarding begins, although onboarding teams sometimes identify that a partner's needs may align better with another product.
- The primary objective of onboarding is to help partners successfully launch and adopt the platform rather than sell additional services.

2. Restaurant-Focused Implementation Approach

- Unlike traditional enterprise implementations, restaurant owners and managers generally have limited time available for structured discovery activities.
- Partners are guided through a phased onboarding process and are encouraged to configure much of the platform themselves.
- Typical setup activities include:
 - Building floor plans

- Configuring schedules and operating hours
- Creating reservations, events, and offerings
- Completing POS integrations
- Running required payment/POS test transactions before launch

3. Variability in Onboarding Duration

- Onboarding timelines vary considerably based on partner engagement and motivation.
- Some partners complete onboarding very quickly ("quick flip" scenarios), while others require significantly more support.

4. Strategic Focus Areas Identified

The discussion highlighted three major business themes:

- Simplifying and automating partner onboarding.
- Improving partner engagement, health monitoring, and retention.
- Scaling operations while maintaining a good partner experience.

5. Large-Scale Platform Migration Opportunity

- Resy plans to move partners to a common backend platform.
- An internal "Resy Importer" initiative is being explored to migrate configuration data (floor plans, shifts, offerings, etc.) automatically rather than rebuilding setups manually.
- This migration affects a large partner population and is viewed as a major efficiency opportunity.

6. AI and Self-Service Opportunities

Several potential AI-enabled opportunities were discussed:

Gamified Onboarding

- Meagan proposed embedding onboarding guidance directly within the product experience.
- Ideas included:
 - Step-by-step onboarding checklists.
 - Progress tracking.

- Incentives for milestone completion.
- Recognition tiers tied to onboarding success and platform adoption.

Embedded AI Assistant

- Ajay suggested embedding an AI assistant ("AI Genie") within the platform to answer onboarding questions and guide restaurant owners through setup activities.
- The concept received positive discussion as a way to reduce friction during onboarding.

In-Product Guidance

- Participants noted that the platform currently lacks walkthroughs or guided tours for new users.
- A guided onboarding experience inside the product was viewed as a potentially impactful improvement.

7. Data and Knowledge Challenges

- Meagan described challenges connecting multiple systems and data sources, including:
 - Resy backend data
 - Tock backend data
 - Salesforce
 - Looker reporting
 - Internal AI systems
- The goal is to establish better visibility into partner behavior, onboarding progress, and churn risk indicators.

8. Post-Onboarding Support Gap

- Tier 1 / strategic partners receive dedicated Partner Success support, goal reviews, and engagement tracking.
- Tier 2 and Tier 3 partners primarily rely on support channels and do not receive the same level of proactive engagement.
- Participants identified this as a potential area where AI-driven assistance could provide value.

9. Relevant Stakeholders Mentioned

Potential contacts for future discussions include:

- **Anuj** (Partner Success leadership)
- **Aaron Ginsburg** (Partner Success)
- **Mary Mapes** (Support leadership)

These teams reportedly have more visibility into engagement metrics, partner success reporting, and retention strategies.

Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Share any available onboarding documentation and materials that may help the team better understand the Resy onboarding process.
Explore opportunities for a gamified onboarding experience embedded directly within the Resy platform.	Meagan	
Evaluate the feasibility of an embedded AI assistant to support restaurant owners during onboarding.	Team (discussion led by Meagan/Satvik/Ajay)	
Investigate available knowledge repositories, backend systems, and data sources that could support AI-driven onboarding experiences.	Team (Ajay's proposal)	
Follow up with Partner Success contacts (Anuj, Aaron Ginsburg) to better understand engagement monitoring, retention metrics, and opportunities for AI enhancement.	Meagan and Team	
Assess AI opportunities for Tier 2 and Tier 3 partner support where dedicated success management is limited.	Satvik / Team	

Emerging Opportunities Discussed

1. **AI-powered onboarding assistant embedded in product.**
2. **Gamified onboarding dashboard with progress tracking and incentives.**
3. **Automated migration/configuration tooling for backend consolidation.**
4. **Churn-risk detection using behavioral and onboarding signals.**
5. **AI support and engagement capabilities for non-strategic partners.**
6. **In-product walkthroughs and guided tours for first-time users.**

Source: From the meeting transcript of *"Resy Onboarding Process"* (transcribed meeting currently in progress).

Satvik's Suggestions - When you get a chance over the weekend, I suggest you guys try out this google chrome extension called as Scribe. It is good for generating how to videos, I'm

taking inspiration from that.

One of the ways we can make the onboarding faster is that instead of giving a “Long” step by step instruction as answer to a Restaurant owner’s query, we can generate a small video which shows where they need to click what they need to fill what they need to select etc like we have prototypes in Figma.

Kind of like generating walkme’s for the process automatically

Product Name - EASE - Experience Assistance for Simplified Execution “This became easy.”

EASE

Experience Assistance for Simplified Execution

Complex journeys, made easy.

1. Vision

EASE is an intelligent experience and execution layer that helps customers, partners, and colleagues accomplish complex tasks without needing to understand the complexity of the systems underneath.

Enterprise applications are traditionally organized around:

products;

screens;

menus;

workflows;

policies;

systems;

teams;

documentation.

But users do not think that way.

They think:

“I want to get my restaurant live.”

“I need to onboard this merchant.”

“I need to resolve this customer issue.”

“Why did this process fail?”

“What am I supposed to do next?”

“Am I doing this correctly?”

“How much is left?”

EASE changes the interaction model from:

Learn the system → Find instructions → Navigate the application → Complete the process

to:

Express intent → Get contextual assistance → Execute with guidance → Validate completion
→ Learn from the journey

The long-term ambition is:

People should not need to understand our systems to accomplish their goals. EASE should make the complexity underneath feel simple on top.

2. Why the Name EASE

EASE — Experience Assistance for Simplified Execution

The name represents both the user emotion and the platform purpose.

The user should feel:

less overwhelmed;

more confident;

more informed;

more in control;

able to make progress;

certain about what comes next.

And the enterprise should gain:

simpler execution;

fewer repetitive support interactions;

better process visibility;

measurable friction;
fresher knowledge;
more consistent execution;
scalable human oversight.

The core promise is:

Complex underneath. EASE on top.

3. The Problem EASE Solves

The fundamental problem is not:

“We don't have enough documentation.”

The problem is:

“I know what I want to accomplish, but I don't know what to do next.”

Even when documentation exists, users still need to determine:

which article applies;
which instructions are current;
where the relevant setting is;
which button to click;
what information is required;

whether the previous step worked;
what remains;
whether they are ready to finish.

This creates friction for both users and the people supporting them.

4. The EASE Experience

Imagine a user says:

“Help me create a floor plan.”

EASE understands the intent and identifies the appropriate approved process.

Instead of returning a long article, EASE begins assisting the user inside the application where the work is happening.

The relevant UI component is highlighted.

Other elements can be visually deemphasized.

A persistent EASE panel shows:

Create Floor Plan

✓ Open Floor Plans

- ✓ Create New Layout
- Add Dining Area
- Add Tables
- Configure Capacity
- Review & Save

Step 3 of 6

The user always knows:

what they are trying to accomplish;

where they currently are;

what they have completed;

what they need to do now;

what remains.

The experience should feel closer to a guided tutorial in a modern application or game than a traditional help center.

5. EASE Is Not Just a Chatbot

A chatbot can answer:

“How do I do this?”

EASE should understand:

What are you trying to accomplish?

Where are you currently?

What have you already completed?

What should happen next?

Did the action actually succeed?

Where did you struggle?

How can the next user's journey be easier?

The EASE operating loop is:

Intent



Context



Journey State



Approved Knowledge + Rules



Next Best Action



Contextual Guidance



Validation



Progress



Telemetry



Human Quality Assurance



Continuous Improvement

6. EASE Assistance Modes

EASE should not force every problem into a chatbot response.

It should dynamically choose the most useful assistance mode.

EASE Answer

For simple questions:

“What does this setting mean?”

Provide a concise contextual explanation.

EASE Guide

For procedural tasks:

“How do I create a floor plan?”

Launch an interactive walkthrough.

EASE highlights:

the correct menu;

the correct button;

the correct field;

the next required action.

EASE Journey

For longer processes, EASE maintains progress.

Restaurant Setup

✓ Business Information

✓ Operating Hours

● Floor Plan

○ Reservation Inventory

- POS Integration
- Test Transaction
- Launch Review

Overall Progress: 43%

This reduces uncertainty and cognitive load.

7. EASE Capture

While users complete journeys, EASE captures structured events such as:

journey started;
step viewed;
step completed;
validation failed;
repeated attempt;
backtracking;
help requested;
escalation;
abandonment;
journey completed.

This means every interaction can become product and process intelligence.

8. EASE-generated Micro-Guides

When a user successfully completes a process, EASE can automatically create a visual representation of that journey.

Think of it as a Scribe-like artifact generated from successful execution.

Instead of maintaining only:

“How to Create a Floor Plan — 17-step article”

EASE can create:

A verified visual journey showing how the task was successfully completed.

Over time, these could become:

interactive walkthroughs;

screenshot guides;

short visual tutorials;

training simulations;

onboarding exercises;

micro-videos.

9. EASE Studio

The human specialist needs a place to manage and improve these journeys.

EASE Studio

EASE Studio becomes the workspace for:

journey creation;

journey review;

knowledge generation;

versioning;

testing;

approval;

publishing.

A specialist could review:

Create Floor Plan

Journey Version: 4

Completion Rate: 78%

Median Completion Time: 7m 42s

Highest Friction:

Step 4 — Configure Capacity

Repeated Attempts: 24%

Help Requested: 18%

Abandonment: 11%

10. EASE Control

Human oversight is fundamental to the concept.

EASE Control

Specialists can:

approve journeys;

edit guidance;

reject generated changes;

flag incorrect guidance;

flag product friction;

review exceptions;

inspect confidence;

manage versions;

control publication.

The philosophy is:

AI can identify opportunities. Humans remain responsible for quality and governance.

11. The Human-in-the-Loop Model

EASE is not designed to eliminate specialists.

It changes where specialist expertise is spent.

Instead of repeatedly explaining:

“Click here.”

“Now go there.”

“Select this.”

“Then come back.”

specialists increasingly become:

journey designers;

quality reviewers;

exception handlers;

process experts;

knowledge approvers;

friction investigators;

experience optimizers.

For Resy, this means the Implementation Specialist can evolve from being the primary navigation mechanism for every restaurant toward becoming the quality controller of the onboarding system.

12. EASE Signals

EASE Signals

EASE can identify behavioral signals indicating friction.

Examples:

- unusually long dwell time;
- repeated clicks;
- repeated validation failures;
- backtracking;
- repeated questions;
- inactivity;
- abandonment;
- escalation;
- unexpected navigation.

Instead of waiting for the user to say:

“I’m stuck.”

EASE can eventually recognize:

“This user may be stuck.”

13. EASE Insights

EASE Insights

EASE can aggregate journey telemetry into actionable intelligence.

Instead of only knowing:

“Users dropped off on Page 4.”

EASE could eventually tell us:

“Users trying to accomplish Goal X repeatedly struggle at Step 4 because Action Y is difficult to locate or understand.”

This creates a new form of analytics:

Outcome-oriented Journey Intelligence

14. EASE and Product Improvement

Sometimes users struggle because the guidance is wrong.

EASE should improve the guidance.

But sometimes users struggle because the product itself is confusing.

EASE should help identify that too.

For example:

Potential Product Friction

Journey:

Create Floor Plan

Step:

Configure Capacity

Signals:

- 31% retry
- 18% request help
- 14% navigate backward
- 2.8x normal dwell time

Product teams can then ask:

Should we improve the guidance—or simplify the product?

That makes EASE valuable not only to users and support teams, but also to Product and UX teams.

15. The EASE Knowledge Loop

One of the largest future opportunities is creating a self-improving knowledge system.

Traditional model:

Process changes

↓

Someone notices

↓

Documentation ticket

↓

Article updated

↓

Users eventually discover it

EASE can create:

Journey happens

↓

Outcome validated

↓

Friction observed

↓

Candidate improvement generated

↓

Specialist reviews

↓

Approved version published

↓

Future journeys improve

The principle is:

Knowledge should increasingly become a governed by-product of successful work.

16. Self-Healing Knowledge

EASE should eventually understand whether its guidance still matches the underlying experience.

Suppose:

“Create Floor Plan”

used to be under one menu.

A product release moves it.

EASE detects that:

the expected component is missing;

users are failing;

another likely component exists;

successful users are taking a different path.

EASE can generate:

Potential Journey Update Detected

The specialist reviews it.

Only after approval does the new journey become canonical.

Therefore, self-healing does not mean uncontrolled self-modification.

It means:

Observe → Detect → Recommend → Human Validate → Improve

17. EASE Maturity Model

The long-term evolution of EASE should be:

GUIDE → ADAPT → PREDICT → ASSIST → ACT

Stage 1 — EASE Guide

Show me what to do.

Capabilities:

contextual answers;

UI highlighting;

walkthroughs;

progress;

validation;

visual guidance.

This is the GrowthHack MVP.

18. Stage 2 — EASE Adapt

Show me what I should do based on my situation.

Guidance becomes personalized using:

role;

market;

product;

configuration;

permissions;

previous actions;
journey stage;
experience level.

Instead of:

“Here are 17 onboarding steps.”

EASE says:

“Based on your setup, you have five things remaining.”

19. Stage 3 — EASE Predict

Help me before I need to ask.

EASE begins detecting likely friction.

Example:

“You're almost ready to launch. One required validation remains. Would you like me to guide you through it?”

The interaction changes from:

User gets stuck → User asks

to:

EASE detects risk → EASE intervenes

20. Stage 4 — EASE Assist

Don't just show me. Help me do it.

Example:

“Set my weekday operating hours from 5 PM to 11 PM.”

EASE prepares:

Monday 5 PM – 11 PM

Tuesday 5 PM – 11 PM

Wednesday 5 PM – 11 PM

Thursday 5 PM – 11 PM

Friday 5 PM – 11 PM

Then asks:

I've prepared these changes. Review and confirm.

The user remains in control.

21. Stage 5 — EASE Act

Complete approved work for me.

For carefully selected low-risk actions, EASE could eventually execute through enterprise systems.

The progression becomes:

Tell me



Show me



Guide me



Recommend to me



Prepare it for me



Do it with me



Do it for me

with appropriate controls at every stage.

22. Initial GrowthHack Use Case — Resy

The first implementation proves EASE through restaurant onboarding.

A restaurant owner says:

“Help me create a floor plan.”

EASE:

understands the intent;

identifies the approved journey;

understands the current screen;

- highlights the correct UI;
- shows progress;
- validates each action;
- detects errors;
- helps the owner recover;
- records journey telemetry;
- generates a visual guide;
- sends the journey to EASE Studio;
- allows the Implementation Specialist to approve or flag improvements.

This proves the complete EASE loop:

Ask → Guide → Complete → Observe → Learn → Approve → Improve

23. Future Application — Merchant Onboarding

A merchant asks:

“Why did my onboarding submission fail?”

EASE could understand:

- merchant type;
- market;
- onboarding stage;
- required information;
- validation errors;

current system state.

Instead of sending documentation:

“Three fields require correction. Let's fix them.”

Future capabilities:

field-level validation;

persona-specific onboarding;

status transparency;

error explanation;

resubmission guidance;

proactive blocker detection;

prefill.

24. Future Application — Supplier Enablement

A supplier asks:

“Why can't I complete registration?”

EASE could identify:

missing information;

mismatches;

incomplete verification;

pending actions;
required documentation.

Then guide the supplier through resolution.

Potential value:

fewer abandoned registrations;
fewer manual interventions;
faster activation;
better visibility into friction.

25. Future Application — Customer Servicing

A customer or servicing colleague says:

“Help me resolve this issue.”

EASE could combine:

customer context;
product state;
current workflow;
approved knowledge;
previous actions.

The experience becomes:

Question → Diagnose → Guide → Validate → Resolve

rather than:

Search → Article → Try → Search Again → Escalate

26. Future Application — Complaints

A colleague handling a complaint needs to understand:

what information is required;

how the complaint should be categorized;

where it should be routed;

what evidence is missing;

what remains before closure.

EASE could provide contextual assistance while deterministic rules validate mandatory requirements.

Potential value:

more consistent execution;

reduced missing information;

reduced rework;

better auditability;

improved root-cause intelligence.

27. Future Application — Complex Implementations

Implementation journeys often span:

multiple teams;

multiple systems;

prerequisites;

approvals;

testing;

errors;

reconciliation;

sign-off.

EASE could maintain one shared implementation state.

Implementation

✓ Requirements Confirmed

✓ Technical Specification

✓ Connection Established

● Test Validation

○ Reconciliation

○ Client Sign-off

Each participant sees:

What do I need to do next?

rather than needing to understand the entire implementation process.

28. Future Application — Platform Migration

Migration is a particularly strong EASE use case.

Instead of asking users to rebuild everything:

Migration Complete: 87%

Needs Your Attention

1. Review configuration mapping
2. Confirm weekend settings
3. Reconnect integration

EASE guides users only through the exceptions.

The model becomes:

Automate what we know. EASE what requires human attention.

29. Future Application — Feature Adoption

EASE should not disappear after onboarding.

Months later:

“How do I create a special event?”

EASE can launch the appropriate journey.

Eventually it can proactively identify relevant capabilities:

“You haven't configured this feature yet. Would you like a quick walkthrough?”

EASE therefore evolves from an onboarding capability into an adoption capability.

30. Future Application — Partner Success

Not every partner can economically receive dedicated human relationship management.

EASE could provide scalable proactive assistance.

Examples:

“Your onboarding has been inactive for five days.”

“One required launch step remains.”

“Would you like help completing it?”

Future capabilities could include:

onboarding health;

engagement signals;

adoption opportunities;

proactive education;

next-best actions;

risk indicators.

31. Future Application — Colleague Onboarding

A new colleague often has the same fundamental question:

“What am I supposed to do next?”

EASE could maintain:

Your First Week

✓ Identity Setup

✓ Mandatory Training

● System Access

- Team Introduction
- Role Learning
- First Workflow

EASE could detect blockers and route them appropriately.

32. Future Application — Colleague Enablement

After onboarding, EASE can continue helping colleagues with:

infrequent workflows;
complex servicing processes;
new product launches;
policy changes;
operational procedures;
unfamiliar systems.

Instead of:

Search for how to do the work

the colleague receives:

Assistance while doing the work.

33. Future Application — Controlled and Regulatory Workflows

Complex controlled processes often require:

sequencing;

mandatory evidence;

approvals;

documentation;

traceability.

EASE could convert complex procedures into role-specific executable journeys.

Instead of:

“Read this procedure.”

EASE says:

“You are at Step 4 of 7. These two pieces of evidence are required before this can proceed.”

For higher-risk workflows, EASE should remain primarily in Guide or Assist mode, with appropriate human decision-making.

34. Future Application — Troubleshooting

Traditional troubleshooting:

Search → Article → Try → Search Again → Support.

EASE:

Error → Context → Diagnosis → Guided Resolution → Validation

The system can understand:

what the user was trying to do;

current state;

previous attempts;

error messages;

known resolution paths.

35. Future Application — Cross-System Orchestration

This may ultimately become one of EASE's largest opportunities.

A user may say:

“Onboard this merchant.”

But underneath that goal may be:

CRM;

onboarding;

screening;

document management;

APIs;

servicing;

approvals;

notifications.

The user should not need to understand that architecture.

EASE can eventually become:

One intelligent experience across many enterprise systems.

36. EASE Next Best Action

As EASE learns from journeys, it can increasingly answer:

Given this person's goal, current state, permissions, history and business rules—what should happen next?

This creates a reusable Next Best Action capability across:

onboarding;

servicing;

implementation;

support;

adoption;
migration;
operations;
colleague enablement.

37. EASE Proactive Assistance

Today:

User becomes stuck → User asks for help.

Future:

EASE detects likely friction → EASE offers help.

Example:

“It looks like you're having difficulty completing this step. Would you like me to guide you?”

Signals could include:

dwell time;
 repeated clicks;
 validation failures;
 backtracking;
 inactivity;
 repeated questions;

approaching deadlines.

38. EASE Personalization

Different users should not receive identical assistance.

EASE can eventually adapt based on:

experience;

role;

market;

product;

configuration;

accessibility needs;

language;

previous behavior.

A first-time user may receive detailed guidance.

An experienced user may simply see:

“Three actions remain. Take me to them.”

39. EASE Voice

Users should not need to know product terminology.

Instead of:

“Where is reservation inventory configuration?”

they can say:

“I want customers to be able to book Saturday evening.”

EASE translates business intent into system actions.

Future interaction can include:

voice;

text;

screenshots;

visual understanding;

contextual UI understanding.

40. EASE Accessibility

EASE can also reduce barriers created by complex enterprise software.

Potential capabilities:

voice-first interaction;

keyboard guidance;

screen-reader-compatible instructions;

simplified explanations;
multilingual assistance;
visible progress;
reduced cognitive load.

The principle is:

The user should not need to adapt to the complexity of the system. EASE should adapt the experience to the user.

41. EASE Journey Simulation

Eventually EASE could help teams evaluate workflows before release.

Questions could include:

Can a first-time user complete this?

Where might they hesitate?

Are instructions missing?

Are required actions visible?

Are there unnecessary steps?

Does the journey contain dead ends?

This extends EASE from user assistance into experience quality assurance.

42. EASE Journey Optimization

EASE can compare:

Successful journeys

against

Failed journeys

and identify patterns.

Example:

Successful users complete Step 3 in 40 seconds.

Failed users spend four minutes there and frequently navigate backward.

That becomes actionable intelligence for:

Product;

UX;

Operations;

Implementation;

Support.

43. EASE Knowledge Freshness

Every approved journey could eventually have:

owner;

version;

last successful execution;

product version;

confidence;

approval status;

last review date.

If the underlying experience changes, EASE can flag:

This journey may no longer be valid.

Knowledge freshness therefore becomes measurable.

44. EASE Process Intelligence

As EASE expands, it can reveal:

unnecessary process variation;

better-performing paths;

redundant steps;

recurring exceptions;

missing controls;

inconsistent guidance.

Human process owners can use this evidence to improve the process itself.

45. EASE Operational Intelligence

Eventually EASE can answer:

Which journeys create the most friction?

Which steps generate the most support contacts?

Which processes require the most human intervention?

Which knowledge becomes stale most frequently?

Where are users abandoning?

Where would automation create the greatest value?

This makes EASE an operational intelligence platform, not merely an assistance tool.

46. EASE Flywheel

The long-term value compounds.

More journeys use EASE

↓

More behavior is observed

↓

More friction becomes visible

↓

Better guidance is created

↓

Specialists validate improvements

↓

Knowledge becomes fresher

↓

More users self-serve successfully

↓

Fewer repetitive human interactions

↓

More specialist capacity for complex work

↓

Products and processes improve

↓

More journeys can move to EASE

The EASE Flywheel

Every journey should make the next journey easier.

47. Why EASE Is Different From Search

Search answers:

“Where is the information?”

EASE answers:

“What should happen next?”

48. Why EASE Is Different From a Chatbot

A chatbot says:

“Here are the steps.”

EASE says:

“You're on Step 3. This is the action you need to take. I'll know when you've completed it correctly.”

49. Why EASE Is Different From Traditional Digital Adoption

Traditional digital-adoption tooling primarily helps users navigate applications.

EASE's larger ambition is to understand:

user intent;
business context;
journey state;
system state;
business rules;
completion criteria;
friction;
outcome.

The objective is not:

Help the user adopt this interface.

It is:

Help the user successfully accomplish their goal.

50. Build vs. Buy

EASE should not attempt to rebuild every technology component.

Commodity capabilities can be bought or reused:

foundation models;
speech-to-text;
UI overlays;

session replay;
generic analytics;
workflow capture;
documentation generation.

The differentiated enterprise intelligence is:

journey models;
business context;
validation rules;
system-of-record integrations;
permissions;
cross-system state;
proprietary friction telemetry;
completion definitions;
next-best-action intelligence;
human governance.

The strategy is:

Buy the rails. Build the intelligence.

51. EASE Platform Architecture

EASE Intent

Understands what the person wants to accomplish.

EASE Context

Understands:

user;

role;

product;

market;

permissions;

current screen;

journey state.

EASE Journey

Determines the approved path toward completion.

EASE Guide

Provides contextual assistance inside the experience.

EASE Validate

Determines whether required actions were completed correctly.

EASE Signals

Detects friction, hesitation, errors and abandonment.

EASE Insights

Transforms journey telemetry into actionable intelligence.

EASE Studio

Maintains journey knowledge, versions, testing and generated guidance.

EASE Control

Provides human review, approval, governance and auditability.

EASE Assist

Prepares recommendations and future prefill.

EASE Agent

Eventually performs approved actions through enterprise systems.

52. EASE Product Family

The name naturally supports a serious enterprise product architecture:

EASE Guide

Contextual guidance and walkthroughs.

EASE Journey

Progress, milestones and orchestration.

EASE Signals

Friction and behavioral signals.

EASE Insights

Journey and operational analytics.

EASE Studio

Journey creation, knowledge generation, testing and versioning.

EASE Control

Human QA, approvals and governance.

EASE Assist

Recommendations, preparation and prefill.

EASE Agent

Governed execution.

53. GrowthHack MVP

The GrowthHack should prove one complete EASE loop, not attempt to build the entire platform.

Hero Journey

“Help me create a floor plan.”

The working prototype demonstrates:

realistic mocked application;

real LLM-backed intent understanding;

contextual UI guidance;

exact component highlighting;

progress transparency;

deterministic validation;

error recovery;

journey telemetry;

automatically generated visual guide;

specialist review;

friction identification;
approval of improved journey knowledge.

The MVP proves:

Ask → Guide → Complete → Observe → Learn → Approve → Improve

54. North-Star Metrics

EASE should ultimately measure successful execution, not chatbot engagement.

Journey Metrics

completion rate;
abandonment;
time to completion;
time per step;
retries;
backtracking.

Assistance Metrics

questions asked;
repeated questions;
escalation;
self-service completion.

Operational Metrics

human touches;
specialist handling time;
exception rate;

rework;

support contacts.

Knowledge Metrics

knowledge freshness;

broken guidance;

journey version age;

approval turnaround.

Product Metrics

friction hotspots;

repeated validation failures;

confusing components;

unnecessary steps.

Business Metrics

Depending on the use case:

time to launch;

time to activation;

time to resolution;

implementation duration;

adoption;

readiness;

engagement.

55. The Ultimate EASE Vision

Today

User:

“How do I do this?”

EASE:

“I'll show you.”

Tomorrow

User:

“Help me finish this.”

EASE:

“You have three things remaining. Let's complete them.”

Future

User:

“I want this outcome.”

EASE:

“I understand your current state. I can complete two actions with your confirmation, guide you through another, and route one exception for specialist review.”

56. The Bigger Enterprise Idea

EASE is not ultimately:

an onboarding tool;

a chatbot;

a knowledge base;

a walkthrough engine;

an analytics platform;

an AI agent.

It is the experience and intelligence layer connecting human intent with enterprise execution.

The underlying philosophy is:

Enterprise systems can remain complex underneath while the human experience becomes dramatically simpler on top.

57. One-Sentence Product Definition

EASE is an intelligent experience and execution layer that understands what a person is trying to accomplish, guides them through the right actions, validates progress, learns from every journey, and progressively enables governed execution.

58. Short Executive Definition

EASE transforms complex enterprise processes into simple, contextual and continuously improving experiences.

59. GrowthHack Pitch Definition

EASE — Experience Assistance for Simplified Execution — helps users stop learning how systems work and start accomplishing what they came to do.

60. Core Brand Promise

EASE

Experience Assistance for Simplified Execution

Complex underneath. EASE on top.

And the long-term product philosophy can be summarized in one line:

Every interaction should be easier than the one before it.

ARCHITECTURE PORTALS

At American Express, technology standards, approved tech stacks, and architecture compliance are governed centrally through two primary hubs: the **Architecture Portal** and **The Amex Way Library**.

1. Architecture Portal (Central Governance & Enterprise Compliance)

The **Architecture Portal** is the central, authoritative platform for enterprise architecture, standards compliance, and governance workflows across Amex.

<https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/ARCPENG/overview>

Key capabilities available on the portal include:

- **EA Design Playbooks:** Enterprise-approved templates and architectural design blueprints.
- **Permit to Build (PtB):** Architectural readiness and compliance gate required throughout the SDLC.
- **API Governance & Certification:** Rules and certification processes for registering Type A and Type B APIs.
- **Architecture Decision Records (ADRs):** Centralized repository for capturing and reviewing key architectural choices.
- **Company Domains & Traceability:** Mapping of business capabilities, applications, APIs, and data.

2. The Amex Way Library (Engineering Standards & Paved Roads)

The **Amex Way Library** is the single InnerSource platform for software engineering principles and tech stack guidance designed by developers for developers.

<https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/EADE/pages/1175394178/About+The+Amex+Way+Library>

It organizes technical guidance into two main structures:

- **Engineering Elements:** Agreed-upon building blocks and recommendations (required practices, smart defaults, and deprecated approaches) covering topics like security, API design, and secrets management.
- **Paved Roads:** Prebuilt, tech-stack-specific blueprints and automation pipelines so teams don't have to reinvent security scanning, deployment, or infrastructure configurations.

3. Key Stack Selection & Platform Guidance

- **Engineering & Tech Stack Selection:** For deciding on application frameworks, hosting, integration methods, and database options, refer to the <https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/TOK/pages/1764307341/Engineering+Guidelines>.

- **Database Standards:** Managed, enterprise-standard database offerings and operational models are detailed in the <https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/ETPDBPE/pages/220299290/Database+Technology+Selection+Guidelines+Operational+Models>.
- **Onboarding Platforms Summary:** If you are building or integrating with customer acquisition and onboarding capabilities, check the <https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/GTJK/pages/2059446460/AMEX+Active+Platforms+Summary> for details on strategic global platforms such as **GO2 / Unify**, **eApply**, and **Apply Platform Excellence**.

TEAM STRUCTURE

Team EASE: Evidence-Based GrowthHack Operating Structure

Team-design principle: Organize around a single end-to-end proof: **business-defined requirements → user-centered experience → integrated technology → business validation → reliable demonstration**. Ownership below reflects verified roles, observable project context, and the specialization you provided. It is **not an employee-performance assessment, ranking, formal reporting structure, or claim that one person is more capable than another**.

Operating rule

One primary owner per workstream, explicit business and tech frequent integration rather than isolated functional silos.

1. Verified current roster

The GrowthHack registration confirmation lists exactly these ten people under **Team EASE**: [Sachin Kumar Wadhwani](#), [Katelyn Winter](#), [Ajay Kumar](#), [Meagan McCallum](#), [Satvik Jain](#), [Akshat Dhingra](#), [SANTANU ANAND](#), [Shweta Jha](#), [Rachel Talentino](#), and [Yashwant](#)., [Sakshi Sahni](#) is not on this confirmed roster and should therefore not be treated as a current core member. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#)

Member	Directory-verified current role and context
Satvik Jain	Sr Assoc-Digital Product Mgmt, Network Capability Delivery, GRC Platforms and Capabilities; Gurugram; manager Angela E Sheppard . [office.com] , [office.com]
Ajay Kumar	Mgr-Tech Project Mgmt, Global Servicing Tech; Gurugram; manager Daniel S Swanson . [office.com] , [office.com]
Akshat Dhingra	Software Engineer III, GRC Technology; Gurugram; manager Rose R Chakkoria . [office.com] , [office.com]
Katelyn Winter	Sr Assoc-Digital Product Mgmt, Ent Digital Experiences; New York; manager Sanum Sheikh . [office.com] , [office.com]
Sachin Kumar Wadhwani	Software Engineer II, GRC Technology; Gurugram; manager Lalit Mohan Tewari . [office.com] , [office.com]
SANTANU ANAND	Assoc-Digital Product Mgmt, Servicing Product Experiences, SC&I; Gurugram; manager Saikat Chakraborty . [office.com] , [office.com]
Yashwant ,	AI Engineer II, GRC Technology; Bengaluru Urban; manager Rose R Chakkoria . The account and email match the intended roster member. [office.com] , [office.com] , [office.com]
Shweta Jha	Software Engineer II, GRC Technology; Gurugram; manager Manish Gandhi . [office.com] , [office.com]
Meagan McCallum	Director-Implementation, Global Dining, Membership Portfolio Services; Lansing virtual location; manager Roberta Meo . [office.com] , [office.com]
Rachel Talentino	Dir I-Operations, Global Dining, Membership Portfolio Services; Salem virtual location; manager Mary Young Mapes . [office.com] , [office.com]

Roster caveat: the official confirmation proves membership, not attendance, activity level, or contribution. Accordingly, allocations below combine formal role evidence, documented project associations, and pragmatic GrowthHack design.

2. Concise factual member profiles

Satvik Jain

- **Verified experience/context:** Product role in Network Capability Delivery. [GrowthHack.docx](#), the EASE Mural export, and the build-vs-buy analysis are authored or modified by [Satvik Jain](#). The EASE material defines the product architecture, MVP, telemetry, scalability story and complete operating loop. [\[office.com\]](#), [\[GrowthHack | Word\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Documented work covers Resy discovery, product definition, GrowthHack pitch framing and the “buy the rails, own the enterprise intelligence” position. The build-vs-buy paper distinguishes commodity guidance technology from Amex-owned journey state, validators, permissions, telemetry and orchestration. [\[ease_vs_wh...911_095717 | PDF\]](#), [\[ease_vs_wh...911_095717 | PDF\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: Product Lead and Pitch Integrator:** scope, problem framing, product decisions, business case, executive narrative and judge Q&A.

Ajay Kumar

- **Verified experience/context:** Technology project-management role in Global Servicing Tech. [GrowthHack_eRally GenAI.pptx](#) was authored by [Ajay Kumar](#) and identifies him as Product Owner for an eRally GrowthHack concept involving Slack, Rally, Python and the Slack API Gateway. [\[office.com\]](#), [\[GrowthHack...ally GenAI | PowerPoint\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Current confirmed member; “GrowthHack Channel Manager” should be treated as a project responsibility rather than the formal directory title. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#), [\[office.com\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: Program and Delivery Lead:** workplan, dependency management, integration checkpoints, risks, demo run-of-show and submission readiness.

Akshat Dhingra

- **Verified experience/context:** Software Engineer III in GRC Technology. Accessible EASE material records participation in the GrowthHack ideation context, but does not establish a specific production technology specialization. [\[office.com\]](#), [\[GrowthHack | Word\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Confirmed roster member and associated with the EASE ideation artifact. The textual extraction is partly corrupted, so it supports participation, not detailed attribution. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#), [\[GrowthHack...9_07-30-55 | PDF\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: Technical Architecture and Integration Lead.** This is a pragmatic project-role recommendation based primarily on the verified software-engineering role and the need for one integration owner.

Katelyn Winter

- **Verified experience/context:** Product-management role in Ent Digital Experiences. She organized the [Resy Onboarding Process](#) connection with [Meagan McCallum](#) and included GrowthHack colleagues in the thread. [\[office.com\]](#), [\[Resy Onboa...ng Process | Meeting\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Direct involvement in Resy discovery coordination and current roster confirmation; no transcript was retrieved, so no specific statements are attributed to her or [Meagan McCallum](#). [\[Resy Onboa...ng Process | Meeting\]](#), [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: Experience Product and Story Design:** requirements articulation, UX acceptance criteria, journey coherence and pitch support.

Sachin Kumar Wadhwani

- **Verified experience/context:** Software Engineer II in GRC Technology. The EASE ideation record associates his contributions with feasibility, documentation availability, SaaS overlap and extension to other portals; the underlying PDF extraction is imperfect, so these are topic associations rather than quotations. [\[office.com\]](#), [\[GrowthHack...9_07-30-55 | PDF\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Confirmed member and included in the Resy onboarding meeting thread. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#), [\[Resy Onboa...ng Process | Meeting\]](#)

- **EASE project lens: Backend, Validators and Technical Feasibility:** state model, APIs/mocks, deterministic completion checks, error handling and build-vs-buy technical inputs.

SANTANU ANAND

- **Verified experience/context:** Product role in Servicing Product Experiences. This gives factual functional context around post-onboarding servicing, although retrieved sources did not establish exclusive ownership of a specific servicing product or feature. [\[office.com\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Confirmed roster member and recipient of the shared EASE package. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: Journey Metrics and Lifecycle Product Support:** metric definition, downstream servicing scenarios and test-case design. The metric ownership is a pragmatic product-role allocation, not a verified specialist claim.

Yashwant ,

- **Verified experience/context:** Identity resolves to the AI Engineer II account in GRC Technology, Bengaluru Urban, reporting to [Rose R Chakkoria](#). [\[office.com\]](#), [\[office.com\]](#), [\[office.com\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** EASE material associates his work topics with graph-based topic modelling, operational-risk themes, interpretability and data-quality monitoring, and records ideation around AI-supported onboarding scalability. Those topic descriptions come from an authored team artifact, not an independent skills credential. [\[GrowthHack | Word\]](#), [\[GrowthHack | Word\]](#)
- **EASE project lens: AI Intent and Context Lead:** intent classification, contextual-response logic, AI evaluation, confidence/fallback behavior and interface with deterministic validators.

Shweta Jha

- **Verified experience/context:** Software Engineer II in GRC Technology, Gurugram. [\[office.com\]](#)
- **Observable EASE context:** Included in the current confirmed registration; [Sakshi Sahni](#) is absent from that roster. [\[GrowthHack...Confirmed! | Outlook\]](#)
- **User-provided specialization: Full-Stack Developer and UI Specialist.** No retrieved artifact independently proves additional frontend frameworks or design-

tool expertise, so allocations use this stated EASE specialization without extending it into unsupported claims.

- **EASE project lens: Full-Stack Experience and UI Lead:** contextual guidance UI, visual hierarchy, responsive demo flows, frontend-to-backend integration and visual polish.

Meagan McCallum

- **Verified experience/context:** Director-Implementation in Global Dining. Her accessible enterprise footprint includes implementation working sessions, Global Dining go-live forecasting, implementation timelines, implementation strategy, specialist discussions and escalation materials; access or sharing associations do not prove sole authorship. [[office.com](#)], [[meagan.mcc...m@resy.com](#) | [Excel](#)]
- **Observable EASE context:** Business counterpart for [Resy Onboarding Process](#) and confirmed Team EASE member. [[Resy Onboa...ng Process](#) | [Meeting](#)], [[GrowthHack...Confirmed!](#) | [Outlook](#)]
- **EASE project lens: Resy Implementation and Journey Validation:** validate onboarding sequence, specialist workflows, launch-readiness meaning, exception paths and where human review must remain. **No software-development allocation.**

Rachel Talentino

- **Verified experience/context:** Dir I-Operations in Global Dining. Enterprise materials shared with or associated with her include Global Dining hospitality scorecards, support inputs, unified monthly scorecards, incident partner outreach and customer-impact materials. These demonstrate functional proximity, not individual authorship.
- **Observable EASE context:** Confirmed business-side member. [[GrowthHack...Confirmed!](#) | [Outlook](#)]
- **EASE project lens: Operational Validation and Pilot Outcomes:** define useful operational measures, validate support/escalation implications, review partner-impact assumptions and challenge whether telemetry demonstrates operational value. **No software-development allocation.**

3. Recommended operating model

EASE's internal design separates intent/context, approved journeys, deterministic validation, telemetry, human review and controlled improvement. The MVP is explicitly one complete floor-plan journey rather than an attempt to build the entire platform.

[\[GrowthHack | Word\]](#), [\[ease_vs_wh...911_095717 | PDF\]](#)

Figure 1: Team EASE operating model: product and Resy business inputs feed three parallel build lanes, with program coordination and integrated validation converging on a reliable demo and pitch.

Workstream ownership matrix

Workstream	Primary Owner	Supporting Members	Allocation rationale
Product Vision & Scope	Satvik Jain	Katelyn Winter , SANTANU ANAND , Meagan McCallum	Product vision and authored EASE framing; product and business partners prevent solution-first scope.
Pitch / Storytelling	Satvik Jain	Katelyn Winter , Ajay Kumar , Rachel Talentino	One integrated narrative connecting user problem, proof, feasibility and operations value.
Resy Business Discovery	Meagan McCallum	Katelyn Winter , Satvik Jain , Rachel Talentino	Implementation process validation must come from the relevant business function.
Business Validation & Pilot Metrics	Rachel Talentino	Meagan McCallum , SANTANU ANAND , Satvik Jain	Operations-led outcome definitions; product converts them into testable success measures.

Workstream	Primary Owner	Supporting Members	Allocation rationale
UX/UI & Demo Experience	Shweta Jha	Katelyn Winter , Satvik Jain	Uses the user-provided Full-Stack/UI specialization plus product journey support.
Full-Stack Prototype	Shweta Jha	Akshat Dhingra , Sachin Kumar Wadhwani	Clear owner for the executable experience and frontend/backend integration.
Backend/API/Validation	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani	Akshat Dhingra , Shweta Jha , Meagan McCallum	Pragmatic technical allocation: engineering implements validators; implementation validates business truth.
AI/Intent/Context	Yashwant	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani , Satvik Jain	Formal AI role aligns with intent handling; product defines semantics; backend enforces deterministic boundaries.
Architecture & Integration	Akshat Dhingra	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani , Shweta Jha , Yashwant	A single technical integrator is needed across experience, AI and validation lanes.
Telemetry/Data/Journey Insights	SANTANU ANAND	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani , Rachel Talentino , Yashwant	Product defines events/metrics; engineering instruments them; operations validates interpretation.
Program/Delivery Management	Ajay Kumar	Satvik Jain , Akshat Dhingra	Formal technology-project-management role and prior GrowthHack Product Owner context.

Workstream	Primary Owner	Supporting Members	Allocation rationale
Demo Reliability/Testing	Ajay Kumar	Akshat Dhingra , Shweta Jha , Sachin Kumar Wadhwani	Ajay owns readiness and run-of-show; engineers own defect correction.
Judge Q&A / Build-vs-Buy	Satvik Jain	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani , Ajay Kumar , Katelyn Winter	Existing evidence-led build-vs-buy analysis plus technical, delivery and experience support. [ease vs wh...911 095717 PDF] , [ease vs wh...911 095717 PDF]
Executive/Stakeholder Alignment	Ajay Kumar	Satvik Jain , Meagan McCallum , Rachel Talentino	Delivery lead coordinates; product and business members supply decision content and credibility.

4. Decision rights

These are **GrowthHack project decision rights**, not enterprise reporting authority.

Decision	Accountable project role	Required consultation
Product proposition, MVP boundary, prioritization	Satvik Jain	Katelyn Winter , Meagan McCallum , Ajay Kumar
Technical architecture and final integration	Akshat Dhingra	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani , Shweta Jha , Yashwant ,
AI behavior, evaluation and fallback	Yashwant ,	Satvik Jain , Sachin Kumar Wadhwani
Resy implementation/process accuracy	Meagan McCallum	Rachel Talentino , Katelyn Winter

Decision	Accountable project role	Required consultation
Operational measures and business interpretation	Rachel Talentino	Meagan McCallum , SANTANU ANAND
Delivery sequencing and dependency escalation	Ajay Kumar	All workstream owners
Demo experience acceptance	Shweta Jha	Katelyn Winter , Sativik Jain
Go/no-go for demo readiness	Ajay Kumar	Akshat Dhingra , Shweta Jha , Sativik Jain
Final pitch integration	Sativik Jain	Ajay Kumar , Meagan McCallum , Rachel Talentino

5. Required handoffs and dependencies

1. **Business truth:** [Meagan McCallum](#) documents the selected onboarding journey, mandatory steps, exceptions and launch condition. [Rachel Talentino](#) adds operational outcomes and escalation expectations.
2. **Product specification:** [Sativik Jain](#), [Katelyn Winter](#) and [SANTANU ANAND](#) convert that input into a bounded story, acceptance criteria, event taxonomy and success measures.
3. **Experience contract:** [Shweta Jha](#) converts the journey into screens, component identifiers, UI states, recovery behavior and demo transitions.
4. **Technical contract:** [Akshat Dhingra](#) defines shared interfaces between UI, AI, journey state, validators and telemetry.
5. **Intelligence and validation split:** [Yashwant](#), interprets intent/context; [Sachin Kumar Wadhwani](#) owns deterministic evidence of completion. The LLM should not declare business completion independently, consistent with the documented EASE architecture. [\[ease_vs_wh...911_095717 | PDF\]](#), [\[ease_vs_wh...911_095717 | PDF\]](#)
6. **Integration and test:** [Akshat Dhingra](#) integrates; [Shweta Jha](#) validates the user flow; [Meagan McCallum](#) validates process fidelity; [Rachel Talentino](#) validates operational meaning; [Ajay Kumar](#) manages defect closure and fallback readiness.

7. **Pitch closure:** [Satvik Jain](#) integrates evidence, demo, business value, build-vs-buy and scaling logic into one narrative.
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6. Lightweight execution cadence

- **Daily 15-minute sync:** owners state completed evidence, next integrated deliverable, blocker and required decision. [Ajay Kumar](#) facilitates.
 - **Twice-weekly workstream checkpoint:** Product/Business, Experience, Platform and AI each demonstrate an artifact, not a status presentation.
 - **Every-other-day integration checkpoint during active build:** [Akshat Dhingra](#) verifies that the current UI, intent response, validator and telemetry event work together.
 - **Weekly Resy validation:** a focused review with [Meagan McCallum](#) and [Rachel Talentino](#); send only process questions, assumptions, metrics and the latest demo slice.
 - **Demo rehearsals:** first for flow, second for timing and handoffs, final with failure scenarios, backup recording and Q&A transitions.
 - **Judge-Q&A preparation:** [Satvik Jain](#) owns the response bank; each workstream owner answers only within their decision domain.
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7. Single points of dependency and backup coverage

Dependency	Primary	Backup/support mechanism
Product narrative	Satvik Jain	Katelyn Winter maintains current pitch outline; Ajay Kumar maintains run-of-show.
Resy process truth	Meagan McCallum	Rachel Talentino validates operations implications; unresolved implementation questions are explicitly marked open.
Operations metrics	Rachel Talentino	SANTANU ANAND maintains metric definitions and test scenarios.

Dependency	Primary	Backup/support mechanism
UI/full-stack integration	Shweta Jha	Akshat Dhingra maintains integration contract; Sachin Kumar Wadhwani supports backend mocks.
Architecture	Akshat Dhingra	Written API/state contracts allow Sachin Kumar Wadhwani and Shweta Jha to continue independently.
Intent intelligence	Yashwant.	Maintain a deterministic intent fallback and preconfigured demo prompts.
Validation services	Sachin Kumar Wadhwani	Akshat Dhingra reviews validator contracts; mocked validation is retained as demo fallback.
Delivery coordination	Ajay Kumar	Shared plan, RAID log, owners and demo checklist visible to Satvik Jain and Akshat Dhingra .

8. Final “who does what” matrix

Member	Primary EASE Role	Core Responsibilities	Key Deliverables	Supporting / Backup Areas	Key Collaborators
Satvik Jain	Product Lead & Pitch Integrator	Vision, scope, product decisions, business case, Q&A	MVP charter, pitch, judge responses	Metrics, stakeholder alignment	Katelyn, Ajay, Meagan, Rachel
Ajay Kumar	Program & Delivery Lead	Plan, dependencies, risks, submission, rehearsals	Integrated plan, RAID, run-of-show, readiness checklist	Stakeholder coordination	Satvik, Akshat, all owners
Akshat Dhingra	Architecture & Integration Lead	Architecture, interfaces, integration,	Architecture view, contracts, integrated build	Reliability, validator review	Shweta, Sachin, Yashwant

Member	Primary EASE Role	Core Responsibilities	Key Deliverables	Supporting / Backup Areas	Key Collaborators
		technical readiness			
Katelyn Winter	Experience Product Lead	Journey requirements, UX criteria, storytelling	Journey spec, acceptance criteria, pitch support	Product backup	Satvik, Shweta, Meagan
Sachin Kumar Wadhvani	Backend & Validation Lead	APIs/mocks, journey state, validators, error handling	Backend services, completion checks, technical Q&A	Architecture, demo recovery	Akshat, Shweta, Yashwant
SANTANU ANAND	Metrics & Lifecycle Product Lead	Event definitions, pilot measures, servicing scenarios	Metric dictionary, test scenarios, insight requirements	Product and business validation	Rachel, Sachin, Satvik
Yashwant	AI Intent & Context Lead	Intent logic, contextual responses, evaluation, fallback	AI service, prompt/evaluation set, confidence handling	Telemetry interpretation	Sachin, Akshat, Satvik
Shweta Jha	Full-Stack Experience & UI Lead	UX/UI, contextual overlays, frontend, visual polish, integration	Working interface, responsive demo, frontend integration	Demo reliability	Katelyn, Akshat, Sachin

Member	Primary EASE Role	Core Responsibilities	Key Deliverables	Supporting / Backup Areas	Key Collaborators
Meagan McCallum	Resy Implementation Validator	Onboarding truth, specialist workflow, exceptions, launch readiness	Validated journey, exception map, business sign-off inputs	Business narrative	Satvik, Katelyn, Rachel
Rachel Talentino	Operations & Pilot Outcomes Lead	Operations impact, support/escalation lens, metrics validation	Outcome framework, operational acceptance questions	Stakeholder and pilot support	Santanu, Meagan, Satvik

Bottom line: run Team EASE as a **product-and-business-led requirements loop feeding three parallel delivery lanes: Experience, Platform and Intelligence**. [Ajay Kumar](#) coordinates the whole system; [Akshat Dhingra](#) owns technical convergence; [Satvik Jain](#) owns product and final narrative integration; [Meagan McCallum](#) and [Rachel Talentino](#) validate that the prototype represents a meaningful Resy implementation and operations outcome rather than only a polished technology demonstration.

GITHUB REPOS FOR INSPIRATION FROM PUBLICLY AVAILABLE CODE

1. <https://github.com/DietrichGebert/ponytail>
2. <https://github.com/thedotmack/claude-mem>
3. <https://github.com/vercel-labs/agent-browser>
4. <https://github.com/abhigyanpatwari/GitNexus>
5. <https://github.com/gastownhall/beads>
6. <https://github.com/upstash/context7s>
7. <https://github.com/JuliusBrussee/caveman>
8. <https://github.com/docker/mcp-gateway>
9. <https://gist.github.com/karpathy/442a6bf555914893e9891c11519de94f>
10. <https://github.com/VectifyAI/PageIndex>
11. <https://github.aexp.com/amex-archives>
12. <https://github.com/amex-eng/architecture-portal/>
13. <https://github.com/amex-eng>

14. <https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/CTOS/pages/1973518564/LaunchPad+-+Needs>
15. <https://aexp.atlassian.net/wiki/spaces/CTOS/pages/1973521625/Gen+AI+LaunchPad+for+GrowthHack>
16. <https://github.aexp.com/pages/amex-eng/amexway/docs/quadrants/languages/Frameworks/one-app>
17. <https://github.aexp.com/pages/amex-eng/amexway/docs/quadrants/languages/Frameworks/one-data>
18. <https://github.aexp.com/pages/amex-eng/amexway/docs/quadrants/culture/growthhackssss>